ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** understood the animal and kept his patience	His patience and affection for Mij are clear.
2	**(b)** it shows closeness	Nicknames show affection.
3	**(b)** were	Verb agrees with the nearer plural subject.
4	**(b)** he was strong, restless and resourceful	Wild animals use their strength and curiosity.
5	**(d)** picture an energetic animal	Vivid imagery.
6	**(a)** clever at finding ways	Resourceful = good at finding solutions.
7	**(b)** panic could frighten and injure the otter	A calm human keeps the animal from bolting.
8	**(d)** to build suspense and humour	Dramatic effect.
9	**(b)** the otter might have panicked	Inference about animal behaviour.
10	**(b)** were unused to wild animals in public places	Strangeness caused fear.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	So that the otter could breathe (1) and travel safely (1).	1+1
12	It shows the otter's natural joy in water (1) and Maxwell's tolerance for his mischief (1).	1+1
13	He makes toys of ordinary objects (1), displaying imagination and intelligence (1).	1+1
14	He is strong and determined (1) and cannot bear confinement for long (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He loved Mij and wanted him close, but the risks were real (1). A stronger box and notice to the airline would have helped (1). Therefore the decision was affectionate rather than prudent (1).	1+1+1
16	A bond of trust has formed (1). Maxwell accepts Mij's nature (1). Mij seems at ease with his new home (1).	1+1+1
17	The air-hostess said that that animal would upset the passengers (1). 'This' becomes 'that' (1). 'Will' becomes 'would' (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He narrates with calm good humour (1). Readers laugh instead of fearing for the otter (1). The tone also shows Maxwell's trust in the animal (1).	1+1+1
18	Both play for sheer joy (1). Both turn simple objects into toys (1). Both need patience from the adult (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Although Mij was wild, he trusted Maxwell (1). 'Although' joins two contrasting ideas (1). The first clause becomes dependent (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	He treats the escape as comedy rather than disaster (1). The passengers' alarm adds fun (1). Yet each scene shows his tender concern for Mij (1). Understatement keeps the tone gentle (1). The result is a warm portrait of a man and his pet (1).	2+2+1
	OR: First-person voice (1). Feeling cramped in the dark box (1). Deciding to escape and the thrill of freedom (1). Surprise at the strange faces (1). Relief when the familiar human catches you (1).	2+2+1
20	Mij is a wild animal from the marsh (1). He tears out of his box and floods the bathroom (1). Yet he comes to rely on Maxwell (1). The bond comes through patience, not force (1). The chapter suggests that wildness and affection can live together (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Comic situations: the loose otter, the alarmed passengers (1). Comic language: understatement and exaggeration (1). Humour keeps the story light yet loving (1). It makes the otter's character vivid (1). Without humour the incidents might seem alarming (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the pet a dog; **Mijbil** is an otter from the marshes of Iraq, taken to London by **Gavin Maxwell**.
- Mixing *Mij* with the author; 'Mij' is only the pet's short name; the author is Maxwell, whose book is **Ring of Bright Water**.
- Forgetting the aeroplane incident: Mij escaped from his box in the plane and caused a commotion before being caught.
- Writing that Mij disliked water; he loved **water**, playing with it in the bath and with rubber toys; give these as proof of an otter's nature.
- Saying the author handled the otter with force; he is patient and learns the otter's moods through **play and care**.
- Spelling slips: *otter, marsh, Basra, Camusfearna, affectionate*; and tense mixing in a narrative summary.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** The box was weak, so the otter tore it open.	'So' links cause to result.
2	**(c)** understanding between man and animal	Central theme.
3	**(c)** a wild animal was loose among the seats	An unpredictable wild animal was moving in the crowded cabin.
4	**(a)** although	Contrast is needed.
5	**(b)** antonyms	Opposites.
6	**(a)** affection that outweighed inconvenience	He valued Mij's joy.
7	**(d)** The otter escaped, which alarmed the passengers.	Relative clause with 'which'.
8	**(a)** humorous exaggeration	Comic overstatement.
9	**(d)** fond, amused and respectful	He loves and respects him.
10	**(d)** jumped suddenly out	Spring = leap.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He understands that play is an otter's nature (1) and his affection outweighs annoyance (1).	1+1
12	Many people fear what is unfamiliar (1), though patience and knowledge can lessen the fear (1).	1+1
13	A quiet manner keeps the otter from panicking (1) and also reassures the passengers (1).	1+1
14	It lightens a risky situation (1) and shows his loving attitude to Mij (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Mij reveals his true nature in water (1). Maxwell sees the joy he has brought him (1). The chaos shows the bond between them (1).	1+1+1
16	Maxwell never struck or shouted at Mij (1). Mij therefore accepted him (1). Affection builds trust across species (1).	1+1+1
17	had broken (1), had hidden (1). Past perfect shows actions completed before another past event (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He escapes a sturdy box (1). He invents games with ordinary objects (1). He finds his way around the new flat with ease (1).	1+1+1
18	He might have been hurt inside the box (1). He might have escaped into the plane or the airport (1). He might have been harmed by frightened people (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He is courteous towards the passengers (1). He remains calm despite the chaos (1). He is humorous about the awkward situation (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	On the plane he stays calm (1). With the passengers and crew he is polite (1). He accepts the air-hostess's help in finding Mij (1). In London he gives Mij water and toys to play with (1). His traits: patience, humour and genuine love of animals (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting and topic (1). Mij as an example of a spirited creature (1). Habitat and freedom matter (1). Our duty to protect and not exploit (1). Closing appeal (1).	2+2+1
20	It shows delightful companionship (1). But it also shows risks: escape, fear, mess (1). Mij needs water and space (1). Not everyone can meet such needs (1). Conclusion: only exceptional care justifies it, and nature remains the best home (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Iraq: natural home, freedom (1). Plane: confinement, tension and comedy (1). London: a new home with water and toys (1). The changes trace Mij's adjustment (1). Each setting adds a different mood (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the pet a dog; **Mijbil** is an otter from the marshes of Iraq, taken to London by **Gavin Maxwell**.
- Mixing *Mij* with the author; 'Mij' is only the pet's short name; the author is Maxwell, whose book is **Ring of Bright Water**.
- Forgetting the aeroplane incident: Mij escaped from his box in the plane and caused a commotion before being caught.
- Writing that Mij disliked water; he loved **water**, playing with it in the bath and with rubber toys; give these as proof of an otter's nature.
- Saying the author handled the otter with force; he is patient and learns the otter's moods through **play and care**.
- Spelling slips: *otter, marsh, Basra, Camusfearna, affectionate*; and tense mixing in a narrative summary.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** Otters are the most charming animals in the world.	'Most charming' is subjective.
2	**(b)** is playful and full of energy	He plays eagerly with water and toys.
3	**(b)** a metaphor	Direct comparison.
4	**(a)** preferred trust to force	He relied on trust.
5	**(b)** he is curious and inventive	Play is a sign of intelligence.
6	**(b)** calmly	Calmly modifies lifted.
7	**(d)** a funny but loving journey with a wild friend	Overall tone and event.
8	**(b)** the contrast between serious plans and the otter's chaos	Situation comedy.
9	**(c)** Mij, the otter, loved the bath.	The appositive is set off with commas.
10	**(b)** uncontrollable delight	He revelled in water.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	She helps Maxwell look for Mij (1) and shows how ordinary people respond to a sudden emergency (1).	1+1
12	Frightened passengers face an excited otter (1), and the contrast between the two creates comedy (1).	1+1
13	Mij is lively in water (1) and restless when confined to a dry, closed box (1).	1+1
14	They make the animal come alive for the reader (1) and reveal his curiosity and energy (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The passengers feared an unfamiliar animal (1). Their alarm grew with Mij's sudden movements (1). Understanding would have reduced it (1).	1+1+1
16	He describes disasters in a casual tone (1). The flooded bathroom is mentioned lightly (1). Understatement makes the narrative funnier (1).	1+1+1
17	Sounds of splashing and scrambling fill the scenes (1). We can picture the wet floor and the darting otter (1). These details bring the animal to life (1).	1+1+1
	OR: In the marshes Mij lives freely among reeds (1). In the plane he is confined and then scatters the passengers (1). The contrast highlights how out of place a wild creature is among machines (1).	1+1+1
18	He had formed a strong attachment (1). Mij seemed content in his care (1). He wished to study and enjoy the animal (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Correct sentence for each word, one mark each (3).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Headline and byline (1). Lead: what happened and where (1). Details of the escape and passengers' reaction (1). Quote from Maxwell or crew (1). Closing note on the otter's safety (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Correct format (1). Hostess is shocked (1). Maxwell apologises and explains (1). Hostess asks about safety (1). They agree to take better care (1).	2+2+1
20	In the marshes he swims and hunts freely (1). In London he must adapt to rooms and a bath (1). He still shows play and energy (1). The bath returns him to his element (1). Adaptability and trust help him settle (1).	2+2+1
	OR: It names the central figure (1). The incidents all concern Mij (1). It sets a friendly tone (1). It lacks mention of Maxwell, but he is narrator (1). Overall it is apt and simple (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the pet a dog; **Mijbil** is an otter from the marshes of Iraq, taken to London by **Gavin Maxwell**.
- Mixing *Mij* with the author; 'Mij' is only the pet's short name; the author is Maxwell, whose book is **Ring of Bright Water**.
- Forgetting the aeroplane incident: Mij escaped from his box in the plane and caused a commotion before being caught.
- Writing that Mij disliked water; he loved **water**, playing with it in the bath and with rubber toys; give these as proof of an otter's nature.
- Saying the author handled the otter with force; he is patient and learns the otter's moods through **play and care**.
- Spelling slips: *otter, marsh, Basra, Camusfearna, affectionate*; and tense mixing in a narrative summary.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND